MARBLED POUND CAKE

MAKES	ACTIVE TIME	TOTAL TIME	OVEN
1 loaf, 23 by 12 cm, 6 to 8 servings	**25 min**	**about 2 h 30 min**	**350F until a knife comes out clean**

INGREDIENTS

185 g	All-purpose flour, for the plain batter
3/4 tsp	Baking powder, for the plain batter
200 g	Unsalted butter, at room temperature, for the plain batter
200 g	Granulated sugar, for the plain batter
1/2 tsp	Salt, for the plain batter
3	Eggs, large, at room temperature, for the plain batter
1	Egg yolk, large, for the plain batter
120 g	Sour cream, for the plain batter
1 tbsp	Vanilla extract, for the plain batter
15 g	Cocoa powder, sifted, for the marble batter
1 tbsp	Coffee, cooled, or water, for the marble batter
1 tbsp	Matcha powder, sifted, for the marble batter in place of the cocoa and coffee

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F and butter a 23 by 12 cm loaf pan lightly.
2. Sift the flour and baking powder together into a small bowl and set it aside.
3. Fit a stand mixer with the paddle and cream the butter with the granulated sugar and the salt, on medium, for about 1 minute. They should come together and lighten in colour.
4. Add the whole eggs and then the yolk, one at a time, letting each disappear into the batter before the next goes in.
5. Stop the mixer and scrape the sides and the base of the bowl with a rubber spatula.
6. With the mixer still on medium, add the sour cream, then the vanilla.
7. Drop to low and add half the flour mixture. Once it is nearly worked in, add the rest and mix until no flour is visible.
8. Transfer two-thirds of the batter to the pan and hold the last third back in the bowl.
9. Work the flavouring into the reserved third with a rubber spatula until it is even. Use either the sifted cocoa together with the coffee, or the sifted matcha on its own.
10. Spoon the flavoured batter over the plain batter in the pan.
11. Draw an offset spatula through the two batters a few times to marble them.
12. Bake until the centre is set and a knife pushed into the middle comes out clean.
13. Move the pan to a wire rack and let the cake go completely cold, then turn it out and set it the right way up.

NOTES

Crème fraîche is not a substitute for the sour cream. Its much higher fat content gives up the light crumb the sour cream produces.
Choose one flavouring for the marble batter. The cocoa with coffee and the matcha are alternatives for the same reserved third, not additions to each other. Keep the marbling passes few either way, because too many merges the two batters into a single colour.
The book gives no bake time for the loaf, only the test: the centre set and a clean knife.
Left unmarbled, the same batter takes 2 tsp lemon zest stirred in before it goes into the pan, then a glaze of 1 1/2 tbsp lemon juice whisked into 125 g confectioners' sugar once the cake is cold. Pour it on, push it to the edges and let it run down the sides. It sets in about 30 minutes.
Airtight, the cake holds 3 to 4 days on the counter, or a week refrigerated.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____ RATING ____ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

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